

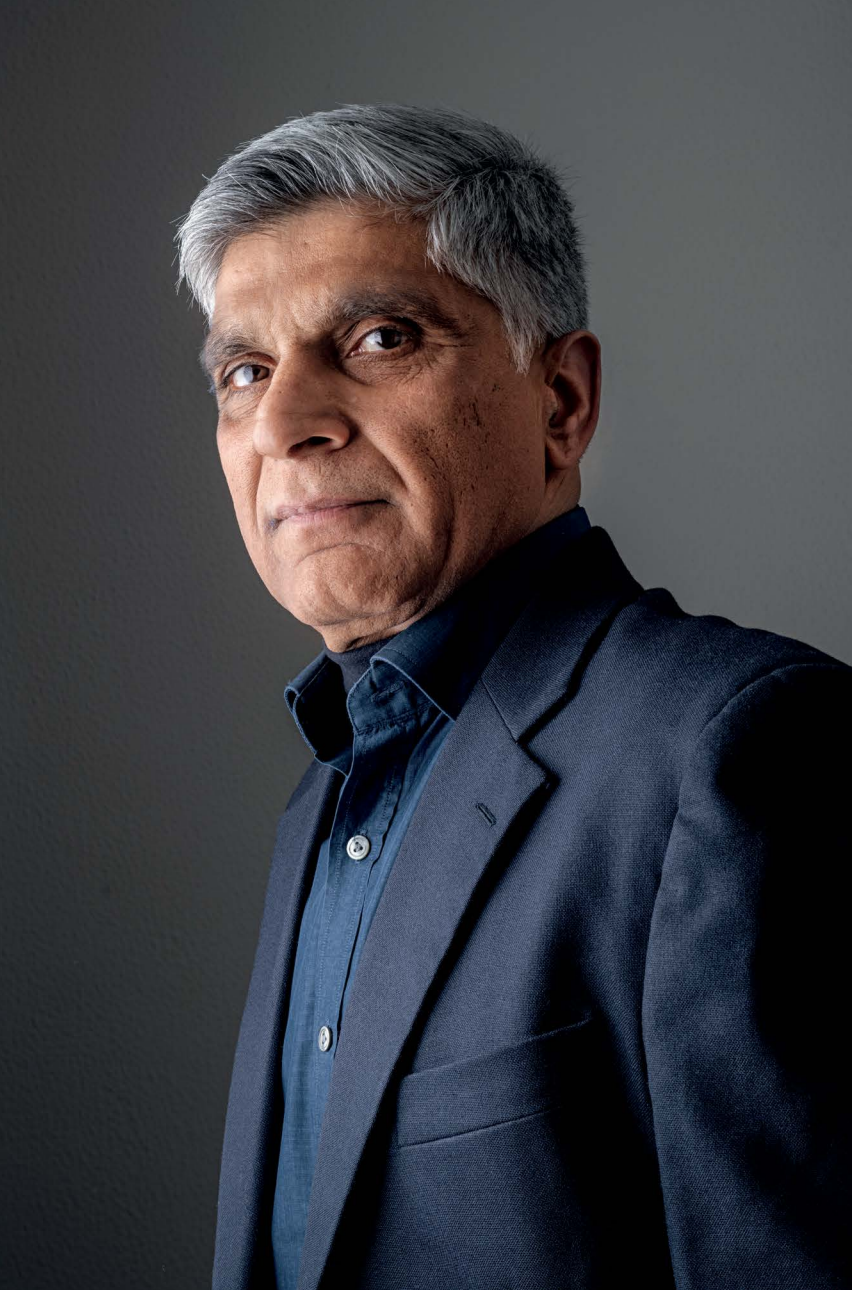


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INSTITUTION BUILDER

Pradeep Gaur, Chairman and Managing Director, RVNL

► Multiple Tracks

❶ Pradeep Gaur took charge as Chairman and Managing Director of RVNL from September 1, 2018

❷ Under Gaur, RVNL listed on the bourses in March 2019 and was granted Navratna status in 2023

❸ He has overseen key initiatives of the railway PSU, including its foray into other sectors such as ports and metro rail

❹ RVNL has also started undertaking international projects with the first such project in the Maldives

❺ It has ventured into manufacturing with Vande Bharat coaches

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non-railway projects such as ports, national highways, metro rail, and irrigation. It has also moved to other geographies, such as the Maldives, where it is implementing a port project. The UTF (Uthuru Thila Falhu-Island) Harbour project in the Maldives is a strategic project placed by the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA), and RVNL was appointed as the implementing agency in December 2022.

Gaur says that not only is the MEA happy with the pace of work and progress, this project has also shattered the general perception that most Indian PSUs do not perform well abroad. RVNL is now also looking at other regions, has signed a memorandum of understanding with the government of Kyrgyzstan, and has ventured into the solar sector in Uzbekistan and the Middle East.

“As of now, we are into four or five sectors. We will see how the situation evolves. We will not like to spread too much. But we would like to focus on areas that are becoming our strength,” he says.

Its order book stands at about ₹65,000 crore, of which around 50% is from the nomination, that is the typical railway projects, and 50% is from the market through bidding.

The challenge now with bidding for projects is to remain competitive and also think of the bottom line, says Gaur. “Getting orders is the easier part; the difficult part is executing them well with margins without compromising on the quality of the work, because that is most important,” he adds.

With this in mind, the company, which was granted Navratna status—which is granted to public sector